

TANAH, TANAH, RUMAH • تنها، تنها، رو ماه

Land, Land, Home — Alone, Alone, Upon the Moon

one stream of sound, two poems: read the middle column aloud — an Indonesian ear hears the left-hand poem, a Persian ear the right

| ENGLISH<br><i>a village day</i>                       | INDONESIAN            | SHARED SOUND (IPA)              | PERSIAN                                                     | ENGLISH<br><i>alone, toward the moon</i>                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>prayer becomes a blurred village</i>               | doa jadi desa buram   | [do.(ʔ)aː.dʒaː.di.de.sa.bu.ram] | دعا جا دیده، صبورم<br><i>do'â jâ dide, sabur-am</i>         | <i>the prayer has found its place; I am patient</i>         |
| <i>the village day and the chickens</i>               | hari desa dan ayam    | [ha.ri.de.sa.daː.na.jam]        | هر عید صدا نی ام<br><i>har 'id-e sadâ nay-am</i>            | <i>at every feast of sound, I am the reed-flute</i>         |
| <i>mother's matter is the foundation of the house</i> | hal ibu dasar rumah   | [haː.li.bu.da.sar.ru.mah]       | حالی بود، اثر رو مه<br><i>hâli bud, 'asar ru mah</i>        | <i>there was a feeling — a trace upon the moon</i>          |
| <i>mother's land inside an oyster</i>                 | tanah ibu dalam tiram | [ta.naː.hi.bu.da.lam.ti.ram]    | تن آهی بود، علم، تیرم<br><i>tan 'âbi bud, 'alam, tir-am</i> | <i>the body was a sigh; O banner, I am the arrow</i>        |
| <i>a moment ago, within kindness</i>                  | tadi dalam budi       | [taː.di.da.lam.bu.di]           | تا دید، علم بودی<br><i>tâ did, 'alam budi</i>               | <i>the moment he looked, you were the banner</i>            |
| <i>we are here; the night is a womb</i>               | kita ada malam rahim  | [ki.taː.ʔa.da.ma.lam.ra.him]    | که تا عدم، علم، رهیم<br><i>ki tâ 'adam, 'alam, rah-im</i>   | <i>for until nothingness, banner aloft, we are the road</i> |
| <i>the deer and the ash are in the house</i>          | rusa dan abu di rumah | [ru.sa.daː.na.bu.di.ru.mah]     | رو، صدا نبودی رو مه<br><i>ro, sadâ nabudi ru mah</i>        | <i>go — you were not even a sound upon the moon</i>         |
| <i>the house has already become a womb</i>            | rumah sudah rahim     | [ru.mə.su.də.raː.him]           | روم حسود، هر آهیم<br><i>rum hasud, har 'âb-im</i>           | <i>Rome is envious; we are every sigh</i>                   |
| <i>the land from before, and the fog</i>              | tanah tadi dan kabut  | [ta.nəː.taː.di.dan.ka.but]      | تنها تا دید عنکبوت<br><i>tanbâ tâ did 'ankabut</i>          | <i>alone, until the spider saw</i>                          |
| <i>land, land, home</i>                               | tanah tanah rumah     | [ta.nəː.ta.nəː.ru.maːh]         | تنها، تنها، رو ماه<br><i>tanbâ, tanbâ, ru mâh</i>           | <i>alone, alone, upon the moon</i>                          |



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composed by lattice search over Indonesian and Persian pronunciation lexicons: every line is a single phoneme stream that the two languages segment into different words • [ə] breathy vowel — its /h/ is heard as a coda by Indonesian (ta.nah) and as the next onset by Persian (tan.hâ)